

Local Procedure 50: Professional Development

Responsible Officer:	UCOP Chief Human Resources Officer
Effective Date:	6/23/2026
Scope:	Professional & Support Staff, Managers & Senior Professionals, and Senior Management Group Members Employees represented by a union should consult their applicable collective bargaining agreement. Policy-covered academic appointees should consult the Academic Personnel Manual. UCOP local procedures apply only to UCOP employees. Employees at other UC locations should consult their respective local procedures.
Contact:	UCOP Local HR Procedure

I. PROCEDURE SUMMARY

This procedure provides requirements for implementation of the systemwide [Personnel Policies for Staff Members \(PPSM\) 50: Professional Development](#) for local University of California Office of the President (UCOP) employees.

II. PROCEDURE TEXT

A. General

UCOP is committed to the development of regular-status employees. The employee and supervisor should define professional development goals together that are related to the University's mission, the department's goals, and the employee's career goals. The dialog between employee and supervisor is essential in defining and selecting activities that align with these objectives.

Discussions about professional development goals may occur at any time during the Staff Talent Evaluation Program performance review cycle and should occur as part of the annual performance appraisal process.

B. Activities

PPSM-50 allows for a wide variety of career-related and job-related professional development activities. UCOP Local HR defines these activities as:

- **Job-Related Professional Development:** Includes, but not limited to, courses, workshops, seminars, industry professional association conferences, cross-training, coaching, internships, and on-the-job training associated with the employee's current position in accordance with the employee's job description.

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- **Career-Related Professional Development:** Related to the development of skills, knowledge, and other qualifications that prepare an employee for other jobs/positions within the UC System.
- **Educational Enrichment Programs:** Related to an employee's avocation or career talents outside the University.
- **Staff Organizations:** Related to an employee's participation in staff organizations recognized by UCOP, such as Employee Resource Groups.

C. Approval of Professional Development Requests

In consultation with the manager/supervisor, the department head will determine whether and how the department will require and support an employee's participation in a professional development activity. The department will consider the following:

- the employee's need for development as reflected in their development plan and career goals identified in the STEP performance review cycle;
- advantages one type of development activity has over the other types available;
- the quality of the proposed development activity;
- the professional development needs of other department employees; and
- the effect of the professional development activity on department workload.
- the department's resources must align with the proposed development opportunities to support employee growth.
- the department head or manager/supervisor has the authority to revoke approval based on shifts in priorities or performance issues.
- the department head and manager/supervisor may request follow-ups post-development activities and will be defined with the employees prior to participation.

The division head has discretion over the reimbursement of tuition, course fees, and related costs and/or paid time off for voluntary attendance at either position or work-related developmental activities.

D. Time Worked

When participation in a professional development activity requires attendance during the employee's normal work schedule, prior approval by the department head is required and participation is considered time worked.

Voluntary participation in training programs outside of regular working hours is not considered hours worked, even if the training is directly related to the job and is funded by the department.

If the employee is required to complete a development program, whether during regular working hours or not, those hours must be counted as hours worked in accordance with the Fair Labor Standards Act.

E. Modification of Work Schedules

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Professional development activities require prior approval from the department head, who may approve adjusted work schedules, with or without a reduction in pay or administrative leave with pay.

For non-exempt employees, the division head may approve adjusted work schedules or administrative leave with pay if the professional development activity is specific to the individual's current position.

For exempt employees, the department head or department designee may approve adjusted work schedules or administrative leave with pay if the professional development activity is either position- or career-related.

F. Leave

Although a general maximum of paid release time for professional development activities is provided in Section III.B of PPSM-50, the amount allowed per employee will vary depending upon the specific activity approved.

III. COMPLIANCE/RESPONSIBILITIES

A. Implementation of the Procedure

The [Chief Human Resources Officer \(CHRO\) of UCOP Local Human Resources \(HR\)](#) is the Responsible Officer for this procedure and has the authority, in consultation with the appropriate UCOP leadership, to implement the procedure. The Responsible Officer may develop other supplementary information to support the implementation of this procedure.

These procedures apply to all units under the jurisdiction of UCOP, including UCPath.

B. Revisions to the Procedure

UC local procedures supplement [systemwide Presidential policies](#). When a systemwide policy is updated, the corresponding local procedure will be updated accordingly.

The CHRO of UCOP Local HR has the authority to initiate revisions to the procedure and ensure that procedures are regularly reviewed and updated, consistent with other UC policies, procedures, and applicable law.

C. Approval of Actions

All actions applicable to employees covered by this procedure that exceed this procedure (i.e. exceptions) must be approved by the CHRO of UCOP Local HR, consistent with the requirements of the applicable systemwide policy. Requests for exceptions to the applicable systemwide policy must be made to the officer described in that policy.

D. Compliance with the Procedure and Applicable Systemwide Policy

If there is a conflict between a local procedure and a systemwide policy, the content of the systemwide policy governs. Individual departments may maintain documented processes applicable to their internal operations or activities, but those processes may not conflict with this procedure or the applicable systemwide policy.

The CHRO of UCOP Local HR is responsible for the administration of this procedure.

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IV. RELATED INFORMATION

- [PPSM-50](#): Professional Development (referenced in Section I)
- PPSM [62](#), [63](#), and [64](#) (referenced in Section III.E)
- [PPSM-2](#): Definition of Terms
- [PPSM-3](#): Types of Appointments
- [PPSM-22](#): Probationary Period
- [PPSM-23](#): Performance Management
- [Professional Development Opportunities at UC](#)
- [UCOP Learning and Development](#)
- [People Management Series and Certificate](#)
- [STEP Process and Timeline](#)

V. REVISION HISTORY

June 23, 2026: Revisions made to:

- **Section B.** Activities. Staff Organizations

May 5, 2025: Revisions made to:

- Streamline and clarify the information provided
- Eliminate redundancy
- Reorganize content
- Update web links and office titles
- Ensure compliance with Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.0

October 1, 2001: Initial issuance of procedure